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Registration No.

46104254

VISIONIAS

Classroom Assignment Sheet

Assignment Code

198497

Name:

JAYANT RUMAWAT

Subject:

MHP

Batch:

RB23

Submission Date:

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Question - What were the main grievances addressed by the Champaran, Ahmedabad & Kheda movements? Illustrate how Grandhiji's strategies differed across these early struggles.

Main Grievances of Champaran, Ahmedabad & Kheda

① Champaran, Bihar @ 1917 - Due to the manufacturing of synthetic dyes in Germany in 1897 the indigo demand crashed in India, causing the European planters to wind off their operations in India. The problem arises when the Europeans convert this problem into opportunity by imposing additional taxes on peasants and demanding increased rent as a condition to stop indigo cultivation, this led to farmers protest which needed Grandhi's intervention.

② Ahmedabad, 1918 - The Cotton mill owners stopped the plague bonus given to workers despite increased inflation amid World War-I, this led to the workers demanding 50% hike in wages but owners only offered 20% hike.

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③ [Kheda, Gujarat 1918] - The Kheda district of Gujarat was severely affected by heavy rainfall, famine, plague & cholera outbreaks. Despite these hardships the British authority increased the taxes by 23%, which the workers found unbearable.

Addressing Grievances through Gandhi's methods of Ahimsa

① [Civil Disobedience movement @ Champaran] - On the request of Raj Kumar Shukla, Gandhiji with other leaders - Mahadeo Desai, Rajendra Prasad, Mazhar-ul-Haq entered Champaran district despite British authority asking him not to intervene. Gandhi disobeyed the order and garnered support which led to

→ Formation of a committee having Gandhi as a member.

→ Report of the committee to be inquired by another committee which led the Europeans to return 25% of money back + enactment of [Champaran Agrarian Act] → Abolition of [Tinkathia System].

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Question-

② Hunger Strike @ Ahmedabad - Gandhi, despite being friend of one of the mill owners supported workers and came up with a "balanced hike of 35%" (exactly between 20% & 50%). When the mill owners brought replacement workers from Mumbai, Gandhi observed hunger strike → Mounted pressure on Mill owners → brought them to the table → Referred the matter to Tribunal on recommendations, workers were given 35% wage hike.

Impact → Workers' leader Amusya Sarabhai created Ahmedabad Textile Labour Association in 1920 to support workers.

③ Rheda Satyagraha @ Guj - Gandhiji started his march from Rheda on 22nd March 1918 as a form of Non-violent protest and asked the satyagrahis to stop paying the revenue.

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This mounted pressure on British authority & later the authority suspended the taxes for current and next fiscal year.

Though, Gandhi's strategies differed across regions but was still centered around his core principle of Ahimsa & Non-violent protests. The "form" of protest adopted with the "needs" & "gravity" of the situation, therefore Gandhi converted the moral principles into working instruments of political action.

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